

Elements of the mobile world match naturally with certain game types, which will lead to new dimensions in game play. Bluetooth for example (a short range radio connectivity / cable replacement technology) which is now built into launched Ericsson phones like the T68, R520 and T39 allows multi-player games without multi-tap add ons, conceivably on different manufacturers' mobile devices. The R520 for instance, allows you to play tennis across the Bluetooth communication link.

Game types like action adventure, role playing, sports games, edutainment, and first person shooter morph through combination with new mobile Internet elements. Swedish company 'Its Alive' enhances the traditional first person shooter game form by adding mobile positioning, SMS, WAP and mobile phones. The game then becomes virtual paintball.

During a game play, the player sends an SMS (or uses his WAP phone) to check his targets real time physical location. If the target is within range, the player can shoot by sending a fire SMS. The damage caused depends on the type of weapon used, the efficiency of the target's shield and other preferences held by the players.

Another Swedish company BlueFactory follows a similar game theme with its newly announced mobile game Hunters & Collectors. This game lets players choose and develop an identity and to challenge other players in close proximity using SMS and global positioning technologies.

But it's not only the specialist entertainment developers who are getting into mobile games. The Disney Internet Group International (DIG) is making serious inroads in Japan as a content provider for iMode. Disney is reported to be engaging in extensive talks with operators worldwide to offer content and applications packages.

UK-based Digital Bridges is busy with mobile games and will produce Star Trek games for the wireless Internet. CEO and